

How to Correct Someone—Graciously

Guide the person toward a better way forward.

THE DEFAULT MOVE

“Let’s do it this way...”

GO-TO WORD TRACKS

1

COLLABORATIVE

- “Let’s handle it this way going forward.”
- “I think it’ll work better if we do it like this.”
- “Next time, let’s try this approach.”

2

QUICK REDIRECT

- “Let’s tweak that just a bit...”
- “Small adjustment—try it this way.”
- “Let’s shift this slightly...”

3

CLARIFY THE STANDARD

- “What we’re aiming for is this...”
- “The goal here is...”
- “The right way to handle this is...”

IF YOU MUST ADDRESS THE MISTAKE

AVOID

“You shouldn’t have done that.”

PREFER

“That created a problem here—let’s do it this way next time.”

Correction People Can Receive

Preserve dignity, lower defensiveness, and keep moving forward.

THE HIDDEN PRINCIPLE

**People resist being corrected
...but accept being guided.**

THE REAL SHIFT

FROM “You did this wrong”
TO “Here’s the better way forward”

WHY THIS WORKS

- **REMOVES ACCUSATION** Lowers defensiveness
- **PRESERVES DIGNITY** Keeps the relationship intact
- **MOVES FORWARD** Focuses on solution, not blame

ADVANCED MOVE: DISARMING LANGUAGE

- “I’ve found it works better when we...”
- “What’s helped me here is...”
- “We’ll get a better result if we...”

WHEN EMOTIONS ARE HIGH: SLOW DOWN • LOWER YOUR VOICE • SHORTEN YOUR WORDS